

Extensions Study Research Questions and Hypotheses

1. Extension Usage Patterns

1. **H₁:** Students with lower starting GPAs are more likely to request extensions than students with higher starting GPAs.
 2. **H₂:** Students in lower-division (freshman/sophomore) courses will request extensions more frequently than those in upper-division (junior) courses.
 3. **H₃:** The most common reason students request extensions will be workload conflicts (e.g., multiple assignments due simultaneously).
 4. **H₄:** Students who typically start assignments closer to the deadline are more likely to use extensions.
 5. **H₅:** Students who report higher emotional comfort with the request process will use more extensions on average.
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2. Academic Outcomes and Performance

6. **H₆:** The number of extensions used will not significantly predict final exam performance once GPA is controlled for.
 7. **H₇:** Students who use at least one extension will have higher assignment completion rates than those who use none.
 8. **H₈:** There is no significant difference in course pass rates between students who used all available extensions and those who used none.
 9. **H₉:** Among lower-GPA students, the availability of extensions will be associated with improved assignment completion and pass rates.
 10. **H₁₀:** Students who cite “emergency or family concerns” as their reason for requesting extensions will show smaller performance declines than those citing “lack of motivation.”
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3. Psychological and Behavioral Impacts

11. **H₁₁:** Students who use extensions will report lower stress and pressure related to deadlines compared to those who do not.

12. **H₁₂**: The availability of automated, no-questions-asked extensions will increase students' overall sense of fairness and psychological safety in the course.
 13. **H₁₃**: Students who perceive the request process as easy will experience greater reductions in stress than those who find it confusing or difficult.
 14. **H₁₄**: Students who use extensions will not perceive assignments as less valuable to their education than students who do not.
 15. **H₁₅**: Students who did not take extensions due to discomfort or guilt will report higher average stress scores than those who took at least one extension.
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4. Perceptions and Policy Preferences

16. **H₁₆**: Students who used at least one extension will rate the overall quality of the course higher than those who did not.
17. **H₁₇**: Students believe that removing the extension policy (replacing it with strict deadlines) would worsen the overall quality of the course.
18. **H₁₈**: Students who perceive extensions as beneficial in computer science courses will also support adopting them in other disciplines.
19. **H₁₉**: Students from private or homeschool backgrounds will express higher comfort levels requesting extensions than students from public schools.
20. **H₂₀**: Students who prefer longer extension durations (more than one week) will tend to report higher levels of stress and workload pressure than those who prefer shorter extensions.